

Agave eggersiana

No common name – a succulent

Family (Asparagaceae)

Kingdom (Plantae)

Status (Endangered)

Description

This species has spiny, succulent and leathery leaves. Those leaves have spines along the edges and at the tip. It is typically dark green to greyish and has bright yellow flowers. It can grow into a sphere, and the diameter may be up to 5 feet long. They reproduce only once in its lifetime by producing a tall spike about 20 feet high.



Location/Habitat

Agave eggersiana is primarily found on the dry eastern side of the Island of St. Croix in the U.S. Virgin Islands. They are currently limited to coastal cliffs with little to no vegetation and dry coastal shrubland vegetation communities in the subtropical forest of said island. When initially found in the 1900's this species was reported from hillsides and plains, but currently it is very rare to find them there.

